MEETING MINUTES

Sync with Bobur

Ziyo Forum — SAP Social Sabbatical · Kick-off Interview

6 October 2026 · 12:04 pm
Duration: 57 min 36 s
Tashkent, Uzbekistan

PARTICIPANTS

SAP Team SAP · Social Sabbatical

Bobur Ziyo Forum · Founder & CEO

Interpreter Ziyo Forum · Colleague

CONTEXT & ENGAGEMENT PLAN

PURPOSE

Kick-off interview to capture the CEO's vision and priorities before the broader discovery series. Conducted in week 1 of a 4-week Social Sabbatical engagement in Tashkent.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Bobur confirmed all information can be shared freely — as an NGO, Ziyo Forum operates openly and has no confidentiality restrictions on their data or plans.

WEEK 1
Discovery interviews across the organisation — CEO first, then functional leads

WEEK 2–3
Execution phase — working directly with teams on priority areas

WEEK 4
Final presentation back to Bobur and full team (~2 hrs, Thu or Fri)

DELIVERABLE
Proposal + prioritised next steps, validated with all stakeholders

ZIYO FORUM — ORGANISATION BACKGROUND

- Founded 2019 with 2 people; now 100+ employees, growing year on year
- Status: NGO — mission to bridge students and government/ministries
- Partners include the UN and multiple international organisations
- University partnerships: Les Roches, Lucerne, Ducas; Russian and now Chinese universities
- Programmes: student exchange abroad, student initiative support, grants for startups

MINISTRY CONSOLIDATION — JUST HAPPENED (4 OCT 2026)

Uzbekistan previously had three separate ministries: Ministry of Preschool Education, Ministry of School Education, and Ministry of Higher Education. **Two days before this meeting**, *all three were merged into a single unified Ministry of Education. This is a significant policy shift — Ziyo Forum's role as a bridge between students and the government now points to a single counterpart, which could simplify partnership and advocacy work considerably.*

EDUCATION GAP — CORE PROBLEM

1.6 million students graduate from high school in Uzbekistan each year. Only 600,000 go on to university — universities have capacity for just 425,000 places. The remaining ~1 million receive no structured further education. Ziyo Forum's mission is to reach this underserved majority with free, motivating educational content and opportunities.

ZIYO APP — VISION & INTENDED DIRECTION

Original intent (Bobur):

Expansion roadmap (priority order):

- Aggregate all Ziyo Forum offerings in one place and track what students engage with
- Motivate participation through **Zeocoin gamification** — reward progress
- Suggest personalised trajectories based on interests (recommendation engine)
- Simplify registration — one app instead of multiple separate sign-ups

Key differentiator:

No single education platform exists in Uzbekistan. Opportunities are scattered across Telegram channels, social media, and university pages. Ziyo aims to be the distraction-free, focused alternative to social media noise.

1. **Events** — current focus; Ziyo Forum's own events first, then partner organisations
2. **Grants, scholarships & news** — consolidated education-relevant information
3. **Community** — student clubs, group projects, peer networking within the app
4. **Gamification expansion** — achievement layers to drive motivation and progression
5. **Media content** — educational media in one trusted place

CRITICAL ISSUES IDENTIFIED

ISSUE	SEVERITY	DETAIL
No single product vision	CRITICAL	IT team, working team, management, and users all hold different mental models of what the app should be. The product pivots toward whoever spoke last. Bobur acknowledged there is no concrete, agreed-upon end state that everyone can execute against.
App still in demo state	CRITICAL	Bobur explicitly described the app as a "demo version" — not ready for serious marketing. No marketing campaigns have been run. The lack of a defined vision is the direct cause; the product cannot be marketed until the direction is locked.
No in-house development team	HIGH	All development is outsourced. Outsource was chosen precisely because the vision was not finalised. Once the direction is clear, Ziyo intends to hire an internal development team — the resources exist, but the trigger is vision clarity.

> **BOBUR'S EXPLICIT ASK TO SAP TEAM**
>
> *"Provide your personal and international experience on what the final version should look like — then we can take it in our own hands and work on it correctly. We need that one concrete vision. That's why we haven't been able to work on it correctly."*

GROWTH DRIVERS & SCALING PLAN

Bobur's priority order for growth:

1. Fix the app and the content — nothing else works without this
2. Expand partnerships to other cities and organisations (Tashkent-centric today)
3. Marketing + showcase real student success stories through the app

Scaling plan:

- Currently outsourced; once vision is finalised, invest significantly and hire in-house team
- Resources to scale are available — the constraint is clarity, not funding
- Long-term ambition: grow to national scale — "the way Facebook started as a student network"
- Bobur cited Uzbekistan has no equivalent platform; Ziyo wants to be first

ACTIONS & FOLLOW-UPS

ACTION	OWNER	WHEN
Review current app state and return with a concrete product vision recommendation	**SAP Team**	Week 4 final presentation
Follow-up interview: deep dive on partnerships and scaling model	**SAP Team + Bobur**	Later this week (Bobur confirmed available)
Interview: Acovir (role TBC) — capture technical/operational perspective	**SAP Team**	Week 1
Interview: Iskander Raka — Head of International Relations & student engagement	**SAP Team**	Week 1
Interview: Serna Raka — Head of Event Managers, event production process	**SAP Team**	Week 1
Final presentation to Bobur + full team (~2 hrs)	**SAP Team**	Thu or Fri, Week 4